
Arsenal and Man City both have three entries in PL XI of the season

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We're basing this Premier League XI on WhoScored ratings, which essentially means Opta statistics and algorithms that generally reward 'doing stuff', so aerially dominant centre-halves are far more likely to be included than calm passers.

Anyway, here we go. At this stage, all candidates must have started 20 of 30 Premier League games.

Goalkeeper: Gianluigi Donnarumma (Manchester City)

An 11th clean sheet of the season came for the giant Italian at Leeds United but then he conceded three goals in two games v Nottingham Forest and West Ham. That he didn't get to make a single save v the Hammers must be bittersweet.

Right-back: Daniel Munoz (Crystal Palace)

Along with Adam Wharton, undoubtedly one of the most valuable players still at Crystal Palace...for now. He made seven clearances and five tackles as Wolves were finally beaten 1-0 to [keep Palace away from a relegation battle](#).

Centre-back: Gabriel (Arsenal)

Probably the best centre-back in the Premier League bar none. Though [he is a dirty, dirty diver](#). Claimed his fourth assist of the season v Chelsea as Set Piece FC triumphed again. And then 23 clearances across two clean sheet games v Brighton and Everton as Arsenal edge towards the title.

Centre-back: James Tarkowski (Everton)

Tarkowski ranks first for shots blocked, second for aerial duels won and third for clearances in the Premier League this season. And ultimately the algorithm loves that. As does David Moyes.

Left-back: Hugo Bueno (Wolves)

Real slim pickings in this position with Nico O'Reilly switching into midfield and Riccardo Calafiori not playing enough games at Arsenal. We eventually fall on Hugo Bueno, who has been excellent in recent weeks. A fully fit Lewis Hall might soon claim this position.

Central midfield: Declan Rice (Arsenal)

Probably the best central midfielder in the top flight bar none. Claimed his fifth Premier League assist of the season v Chelsea as Arsenal once again relied on set-pieces. And he's rather good at set-pieces. [He was 'nervy' v Brighton, mind](#).

Central midfield: James Garner (Everton)

A new entry after his fifth Premier League assist of the season v Burnley. He's versatile and he has brilliant set-piece delivery; [in any other year he might be in England contention](#).

Right wing: Bukayo Saka (Arsenal)

We're not altogether sure why Saka is still in this Premier League XI with only six goals and three assists but we suspect his defensive numbers and diligence are playing a big part here. His pass completion rate was a woeful 61.3% in the north London derby and dropped even lower v Chelsea. Against Brighton it was just 50%.

Attacking midfield: Bruno Fernandes (Manchester United)

Probably the best player in the Premier League right now, he has logged a ludicrous 16 Premier League assists this season. We have [ranked them all here](#).

Left wing: Antoine Semenyo (Manchester City)

Now has 15 Premier League goals this season after scoring in blue v Wolves, Tottenham, Fulham, Leeds United and Nottingham Forest; only Erling Haaland and Igor Thiago have scored more. He was one of [our transfer window winners](#).

Striker: Erling Haaland (Manchester City)

The goals have dried up a little but he still has 22 Premier League goals in 29 games, which is not too shabby. And there was a seventh assist of the season v Newcastle. Only Fernandes and Rayan Cherki have more this season so far.

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